Mitacs BSI Application Template

Template version: 2025-11-26

Upon submitting your application, you are agreeing that Mitacs can post the title of your project, the public project overview, the name of the partner organization (if applicable), the name of the intern, the name of the academic supervisor, and the involved academic institution on www.mitacs.ca/en/projects and this information may be used by Mitacs to publicize its programs. Mitacs Privacy Policy can be found at www.mitacs.ca/en/privacy-policy.

Section 1: Project Overview

P-1.1 Title (255 characters max)

Note: This can be changed later

Vision One Million Scorecard: An Integrated Framework for Regional Growth Readiness

P-1.2 Size of application

☒ Small (1-3 internships)

Expert review should take no more than 6 weeks for the majority of proposals. Please plan for additional review time should revisions be requested. Your project start date will only be confirmed once the proposal is approved, intern(s) identified, and partner organization funds received at Mitacs.

☐ Medium (6-10 internships)

Expert review should take no more than 8 weeks for the majority of proposals. Please plan for additional review time should revisions be requested. Your project start date will only be confirmed once the proposal is approved, intern(s) identified, and partner organization funds received at Mitacs.

P-1.3 Public Project Overview (100-200 words)

Using simplified language, please provide a general one-paragraph description of the proposed project including the expected benefit to the partner organization.

The population in the Waterloo Region is expected to grow from approximately 678,000 residents (as of year-end, 2024) to one million by 2050 – an increase of over 300,000 people. Local leaders recognize that the Region's current infrastructure is not advancing at the pace needed to support this expansion, creating an urgent need for coordinated tracking and planning.

The Future Cities Institute (FCI) at the University of Waterloo has partnered with the Greater Kitchener-Waterloo Chamber of Commerce (GKWCC) to develop and implement the *Vision One*

Million Scorecard. This comprehensive tool monitors the Region's readiness across five critical sectors: housing, transportation, healthcare, employment and placemaking.

The scorecard integrates existing municipal data with evidence-based benchmarks derived from comparative metropolitan research and validated through expert consultation with local stakeholders. By presenting readiness scores in an accessible, unified format, the scorecard enables stakeholders to understand infrastructure gaps across all sectors simultaneously, promoting accountability, informed decision-making and coordinated action.

P-1.4 Academic discipline

Please highlight the academic discipline (1 only) that most closely aligns with the project.

- ☒ Business
- ☐ Computer Science
- ☐ Earth Science
- ☐ Engineering
- ☐ Life Science
- ☐ Mathematical Science
- ☐ Physical Science
- ☐ Social Science, Arts and Humanities

P-1.5 Keywords to identify reviewers

Please specify five to ten keywords to help identify proper reviewers and to accelerate the review process. Please provide both technically and/or conceptually related (50%) and discipline related keywords (50%).

Conceptually/technically-related keywords (50%)	Discipline-related keywords (50%)
• Benchmarking • Population growth forecasting • Capacity planning • Regional analytics • Infrastructure readiness assessment	• Community engagement • Growth projection • Impact tracking • Research presentation • Regional planning • Economic development

Section 2: Academic Supervisor Details

P-2.1a Academic Supervisor details

Please complete the following table for each academic supervisor included on the project (copy the table as necessary).

ACADEMIC SUPERVISOR FULL NAME	
First name:	Leia
Last name:	Minaker
Email:	lminaker@uwaterloo.ca
Re-type email:	lminaker@uwaterloo.ca
Contact phone:	519-888-4567
Extension:	45615
Academic institution:	University of Waterloo
Department:	School of Planning
Address:	200 University Avenue West
City:	Waterloo
Province:	Ontario
Country:	Canada
Postal code:	N2L 3G1

P-2.1b Academic Supervisor Policy on Sensitive Technology Research and Affiliations of Concern Declaration

1. Are you currently affiliated with, or in receipt of funding or in-kind support from any of the listed Named Research Organizations (NROs)?

   ☐ Yes ☒ No

   Any applicant who is currently affiliated with, or in receipt of funding or in-kind support from one or more of the institutions on the list of NROs is not eligible to participate in a Mitacs-funded project involving research that aims to advance a Sensitive Technology Research Area (STRA). Mitacs will also screen a sample of applications, selected at its sole discretion, and validate the accuracy of the completed declarations. Mitacs reserves the right to decline funding, at any point, for a project that advances a sensitive technology research area because of affiliations of concern.

P-2.1c Academic supervisor CV

The academic supervisor must upload a CV/resume for any application that will involve 6 or more internships. Please note by uploading your Resume/CV you are granting all participants in this application and Mitacs staff access to this document.

Not required for this application.

Section 3: Partner Organization Information

P-3.1 Organizational Profile

Please complete the following table for each partner organization included on the project (copy the table as necessary)

PARTNER ORGANIZATION Organization Name (Primary contact)			
Partner Contact Information			
First name:		Last name:	
Email:		Re-type email:	
Department:			
Contact phone:		Extension:	
Business Information			
Legal Organization Name:			
Organization URL:			
Industry code (NAICS):			
Legal Status: (For Canadian Organizations only)	☐ For Profit Canadian Corporation ☐ Not for Profit Canadian Corporation ☐ Crown Corporation ☐ Municipality		
Organization Size: (Number of employees in Canada)	☐ 1 – 49 ☐ 50 – 99 ☐ 100 – 499 ☐ 500 – 999 ☐ 1000+		
Address:			
City:		Province:	
Country:		Postal code:	
Organizational Structure and Activities			
Is the organization incorporated?	☐ Yes ☐ No	**If yes,** *please include the date (YYYY/MM/DD) of incorporation:* RESPONSE	
Is the organization a parent company?	☐ Yes ☐ No	**If yes,** please describe (e.g., main subsidiaries, name of the parent company/holding company, city and country where the headquarters of the parent company/holding company are located): RESPONSE	
Is the organization a subsidiary company?	☐ Yes ☐ No	**If yes,** please describe (e.g., main subsidiaries, name of the parent company/holding company, city and country where the headquarters of the parent company/holding company are located): RESPONSE	

PARTNER ORGANIZATION Organization Name (Primary contact)		
Does the organization have an R&D department in Canada?	☐ Yes ☐ No	**If yes,** what is the exact number of research and development (R&D) staff in Canada? RESPONSE **If no,** is R&D conducted on the organization's premises in Canada? RESPONSE
Is this the first time the partner has collaborated with the academic institution?	☐ Yes ☐ No	
Funds Declaration		
Have the funds committed by the Organization been leveraged against other federal or provincial programs?	☐ Yes ☐ No	**If yes,** Please contact your Mitacs Advisor before you proceed with the application. **If yes,** please identify the Program Name(s): RESPONSE **If yes,** please indicate the Total Program(s) Contribution: RESPONSE
Invoicing Information		
How often will the partner organization be invoiced?	☐ Every 4 months ☐ Annually ☐ Single payment	
Net invoice term (Days >=30)		
Accounts payable attention to:		
First name:		
Last name:		
Email:		
Phone:		
Extension:		
Please describe any applicable invoice requirements:	RESPONSE	

Section 4: Project details

4.1 PROJECT DESCRIPTION

A-4.1a Background (What problem needs to be solved?)

Provide an overview and describe the main activities of the partner organization. Explain the innovation challenge or improvement priority that the partner needs to solve. Specify how this project will help the partner organization address those challenges in a way that goes beyond day-to-day business operations/activities. Describe what kind of expertise is required to solve the problem.

Overview of partner organization

The Greater Kitchener Waterloo Chamber of Commerce (GKWCC) acts as a strong advocate for continued community development and a partner for prosperity by connecting, educating, and developing the business community through networking events, educational programs, and advocacy. A portion of the GKWCC's advocacy efforts involve working with all levels of government on issues related to taxation, business regulations, land supply, economic development and essential public services. Of note, the GKWCC's Physician Recruitment efforts have helped bring 150+ family physicians to the Region, demonstrating their commitment to community development beyond traditional business advocacy.

Together with the Business and Economic Support Team of Waterloo Region (BestWR), the GKWCC is advancing its advocacy efforts through the development and implementation of the Vision One Million Scorecard.

Description of current challenge

The Waterloo Region stands at the threshold of massive growth, with projections indicating that the Region's population will grow from approximately 678,000 residents (as of year-end, 2024) to one million by 2050 — an increase of over 300,000 people. Currently, our housing supply, transportation infrastructure, healthcare services, employment opportunities, and social infrastructure are not advancing at the pace needed to support this population boom. Local leaders recognize that the Region's current infrastructure is not advancing at the pace needed to support this expansion, creating an urgent need for coordinated monitoring and planning.

In response, the Greater Kitchener-Waterloo Chamber of Commerce (GKWCC) and the Future Cities Institute (FCI) at the University of Waterloo are developing and implementing the Vision One Million Scorecard (the "Scorecard"), a unified framework that measures infrastructure readiness across five key pillars that are vital to regional operations and community support. These include: housing, transportation, healthcare, employment, and placemaking.

The team has conducted an expansive review across the five key pillars listed above to understand what it takes to support a population of one million people. This involved reviewing all aspects of community and population growth, leveraging the knowledge and experience of metropolitan areas across the globe, and reflecting on how the needs of the Region of Waterloo may differ from other communities.

In general, current efforts to assess growth readiness remain inconsistent and fragmented across industries and sectors, making it difficult to develop a comprehensive understanding of the infrastructure requirements necessary to support the Region of Waterloo's projected growth. This project aims to address this critical gap in growth readiness monitoring by:

1. identifying evidence-based approaches for municipalities to measure infrastructure readiness,
2. establishing benchmarks and targets that align with best practices while accounting for the region's unique context and needs, and
3. developing a framework that can be adapted and scaled to other municipalities facing similar growth challenges.

By addressing the interconnected social, economic and political challenges inherent in preparing a Region for tremendous population growth, the Scorecard will promote accountability, informed decision-making and coordinated action.

Impact of project

This project will significantly enhance the GKWCC's advocacy efforts by establishing a long-term, data-driven infrastructure monitoring system that will inform and strengthen how the Region prepares for and supports sustained population growth. The Scorecard creates an enduring framework that transcends short-term priorities and individual initiatives, positioning the GKWCC as a convener of cross-sectoral collaboration that brings together municipal governments, academic institutions, community organizations, and civil society around shared metrics and collective responsibility for outcomes.

By providing a clear and accurate picture of which infrastructure investments should be prioritized to support municipal growth, the Scorecard will enable coordinated action across all sectors, transforming population growth from a resource worry to an opportunity for the Region of Waterloo. This positions the GKWCC as a key player in driving this transformation while contributing meaningful knowledge to the broader field of municipal growth planning through a scalable framework that can be adapted by other regions experiencing similar population growth.

Expertise required to solve the problem

Specialized expertise required to develop this solution includes (but is not limited to):

- Proficiency in data collection and analysis
- Experience working across interdisciplinary teams with diverse subject matter expertise
- Ability to integrate multiple perspectives and adapt communication approaches for different stakeholder groups

A-4.1b Objectives and Approach (How will the problem be solved?)

State the objectives for this project and explain how you plan to accomplish them. Enough detail should be provided so that it is clear whether the described approach is appropriate to achieve each objective. For projects with more than one intern, clearly explain which objective(s) each intern will work on.

This project has XX main objectives:

Consultation – month 1
Data gathering, synthesis and analysis – 2,3,4
Drafting next interation of the scorecard – 4,5
Soft launch – to make sure
Actual release - 6
Early January there will be a meeting with the Mayors and CAOs – to see if what we have is

OBJECTIVE 1: Validate metrics through stakeholder engagement
Engage regional stakeholders (including municipal leaders, academic experts, community organizations, industry representatives and civil society) to assess the suitability, usability, and feasibility of the established benchmarks, ensuring they reflect local priorities and are practical for ongoing monitoring and decision-making.

Activities related to Objective 2 may include (but are not limited to) the following:

- Identify/map relevant stakeholders for engagement
    - Tasks for the Mitacs Intern could include:
        - Developing engagement strategy (including stakeholder identification and mapping)
        - Conducting stakeholder outreach and recruitment
- Carry out consultation sessions as required
    - Tasks for the Mitacs Intern could include:
        - Organizing and conducting semi-structured interviews with key stakeholders to ensure relevant and current data are captured.
        - Delivering research presentations to various government and community roundtables (e.g., Government Relations table for the Community Safety and Wellbeing Plan)
- Refinement and validation of proposed metrics based on feedback
    - Tasks for the Mitacs Intern could include:
        - Feedback analysis and synthesis
        - Documentation and reporting

OBJECTIVE 2: Launch and Disseminate the Vision One Million Scorecard
Publicly launch the Scorecard as an accessible, user-friendly tool that enables stakeholders, policymakers and community members to monitor infrastructure readiness across the Region of Waterloo.

Activities related to Objective 2 may include (but are not limited to) the following:

- Develop documentation and resources to support launch
    - Tasks for the Mitacs Intern could include:
        - Supporting project leads in the development of communication materials (e.g., developing user guides, tutorials, visual aids to help users navigate the platform)
- Draft Scorecard based on Objective 1 activities results and documentation activities

- Finalize the publicly accessible digital platform (development to begin prior to funding period)
    - Tasks for the Mitacs intern could include:
        - Quality assurance (e.g., reviewing written content for clarity, consistency, and accuracy; verifying that data visualizations are clearly labeled and interpretable, etc.)
        - Supporting project leads in the development of communication materials (e.g., development of a communication strategy and associated materials explaining how to access and use the Scorecard, etc.)

- Conduct outreach to ensure broad awareness and uptake among key audiences
    - Tasks for the Mitacs Intern could include:
        - Organizing and facilitating testing sessions with target user groups
        - Compiling and synthesizing feedback for the development team
        - Tracking outstanding issues and following-up on resolution

A-4.1c Timeline (Who will solve the problem and how much effort will be required?)

*Insert a timeline showing **which task(s)** will be performed **when**, and by **which intern** in order to achieve the objectives stated above (consider breaking this down by week for shorter projects or by month for longer projects via a Gantt chart). Ensure there are no gaps in the timeline and that the effort required to complete each task matches the amount of time allocated for each intern.*

The project will proceed as follows:

TASK	PROJECT MONTHS								RESPONSIBLE
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	

A-4.1d Deliverables (What does success look like?)

List the deliverables or tangible results *you expect from the project and identify which intern is responsible for it. For example, will you develop a new patent/prototype/product/service, business model, business process, or will you access new markets? Will the intern be expected to produce a report, evaluation, presentation, etc.?*

The following are some ideas from the Accelerate application:

- ☐ Reports for the partner organization
- ☐ Presentations to the partner organization's staff
- ☐ Patent applications
- ☐ Conference presentations
- ☐ New research tools or methods
- ☐ Other intellectual property claims (copyrights, trademarks, industrial designs)
- ☐ Plans to commercialize a new technology
- ☐ New products or services
- ☐ Opportunities for the partner organization to hire new staff
- ☐ Expansion to new markets
- ☐ Publication in peer-reviewed journals, book chapters or technical publications
- ☐ Thesis chapter(s)
- ☐ Other (if other, please specify):

Vision One Million Scorecard:
The intern will be responsible for the creation of a mock-up interactive Scorecard that will eventually be migrated to a dedicated website. – website should be finished in December

Reports for the partner organization
The intern will be responsible for the creation of documentation that outlines data sources, data analysis, and findings from stakeholder interviews. The document will contain all information to be placed on the final Vision One Million Scorecard.

Presentations to stakeholders
The intern will be responsible for presenting data analysis findings to stakeholders, such as Regional government workers, to identify gaps in the Scorecard's understanding of current work. Further, there will be opportunity to receive feedback on the feasibility of recommendations made by the Scorecard regarding proposed governmental action.

New research tools or methods:
The intern will be responsible for the documentation of their progress throughout the term. From this, a process-focused document will be created by the intern that provides an overview of steps taken to collect and analyze information used on the scorecard.

Establishing longer term directions and data sharing agreements for how to access the data moving forward

Progress to date

The team has conducted an expansive review across the five key pillars to understand the infrastructure needs required to support a population of one million people. This review involved considering all aspects of community and population growth, leveraging the knowledge and experience of metropolitan areas across the globe, and reflecting on how the needs of the Region of Waterloo may differ from other communities.

The review resulted in the identification of key metrics that the team believed would be valuable to include on the Scorecard, leading to the preparation of an initial draft. The team then engaged local leaders and stakeholders to validate the proposed metrics and ensure that the Scorecard reflected the priorities, challenges, and opportunities specific to the Region of Waterloo.

Next steps
Based on the

A-2.2 INTERNSHIP BENEFITS

A-4.2a Benefits and Impacts to Canada

If this project potentially impacts broader challenges that society or the industry faces, please describe how the project will help address these challenges. Why are these contributions important?

Impact on Society

The BestWR Scorecard project, specifically pertaining to process documentation, will be invaluable in supporting communities across Canada as they prepare for population growth in their communities. This project will provide a clear process, as well as completed product, demonstrating how communities can find and solve resource gaps through community engagement and partnerships. The completed Scorecard acts as a "proof of concept" document, whereas the progress documentation forms a "do it yourself" guide. Through this, the growth and betterment of communities across Canada will be supported.

Importance

This contribution is important because the population size and demographic makeup of many communities in Canada are changing. For example, Waterloo Region has become the fastest-growing metropolitan area in Canada over the last 10 years, as well as the youngest. Even still, our population is aging, and consideration needs to be placed on how the community wishes to develop infrastructure and resources going forward. This story is playing out in many other communities across the country, and it will be beneficial to be able to learn from our findings.

A-4.2b Benefits to the Intern(s)

Explain how participating in this project aligns with the academic studies of the intern(s). How is participating in the project expected to benefit their future career(s)? For example, will they expand their professional network, gain knowledge in a business context, or develop skills in problem-solving, communication, project management, creative thinking, etc.?

This project aligns with the future career goals of the intern. In addition to providing a wealth of connections within the University of Waterloo and wider Waterloo Region, it supports their research and writing abilities, project management skills, and research dissemination abilities. These skills and connections will continue to serve the intern throughout their undergraduate career, and will lay the foundations for future work in any research-oriented field.

A-4.3 INTERNSHIP ENVIRONMENT

A-4.3a Description of the Academic Internship Environment

a. *Please describe the nature of academic supervision during the internship period. Explain the **type and frequency of interactions** (e.g., meetings, phone calls, etc.) between the intern and academic supervisor.*

The intern will communicate with the supervisor through bi-weekly teams meetings, in addition to the occasional in-person meeting. Meetings will serve as progress updates and assist the supervisor in working through any difficulties experienced by the intern throughout the course of the project.

b. *Will the project make use of the resources and/or facilities of the academic institution? If so, please describe.*

The intern will have an on-site office located at the University of Waterloo.

A-4.3b Description of the Partner Internship Environment

a. *Please state the nature of the partner interaction:* ☐ *Onsite* ☒ *Virtual* ☐ *Hybrid*

b. *Describe the working environment at the partner organization and the type and frequency of interactions between the intern(s) and employees. For example, what resources, facilities/equipment, and specialized training will the intern(s) have access to? If the intern(s) will work virtually, how will they be exposed to the activities and culture of the partner organization?*

The intern will meet with the partner organization once per month, with additional meetings scheduled when required for the project. The intern will have access to the network of contacts provided by the partner organization, as well as software and employee assistance in creating the foundations for the Scorecard website.
The intern will have the opportunity to engage in the culture of the partner organization through regular roundtables and engagement events.

A-4.4 PAST/OTHER MITACS PROJECTS

Is this application related to, or a continuation of, any previous or current Mitacs projects?

☐ *Yes*

☒ *No*

*If **Yes**, provide specifics about the relationship(s), including relevant project IT#(s). If the current project is a continuation of prior work, briefly describe how it meaningfully furthers what has been previously achieved.*

N/A

A-4.5 ENGAGEMENT WITH INDIGENOUS COMMUNITIES OR PARTNERS (IF APPLICABLE)

Projects that involve or impact Indigenous communities must comply with the Mitacs Indigenous Research Policy. Describe (1) Indigenous community support for the project, and their role in shaping its objectives/approach, (2) plans for Indigenous community access, use, and governance of resulting knowledge/data, and (3) the team background in Indigenous research, including planned training/mentorship the intern(s) will receive to address deficits in experience.
You may also submit 1-2 letter(s) of support from Indigenous Elders who are members of the partner community/communities and possess the authority to speak on community interests.

N/A

A-4.6 INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY (IF APPLICABLE)

*Explain how this project supports the **creation and/or ownership of IP** for the partner organization. If the project provides **education or training about IP** for any of the participants, explain here.*

Insert text

A-4.7 REFERENCES / SOURCES (IF APPLICABLE)

List any references you have cited in your proposal.

N/A

Section 5: Internship Budget and Schedule

P-5.1 SUMMARY OF INTERNSHIPS

Please select only one type of internship option per application from the list below. If you want to apply for internships of a different type, you will need to create a separate application. Each of your applications can include up to 10 internships of the same type. If you select an internship option with project costs, you must include a description of how these fundings will be used in your project proposal.

☐ **Business Strategy Internship (BSI) Standard Funding:**
Each BSI internship unit is valued at $10,000 and the partner organization's financial contribution starts at $5,000 per unit. Each intern receives a minimum of $10,000 stipend per unit

☐ **Business Strategy Internship (BSI) Standard Funding plus Project Costs:**
Each BSI internship unit is valued at $15,000 and the partner organization's financial contribution starts at $7,500 per unit. Each intern receives a minimum $10,000 stipend per unit. The additional $5,000 in funds can be used to pay for eligible project costs or can be used to top-up the intern stipend to $15,000.

☐ **Business Strategy Internship (BSI) - Indigenous Pathways Reduced Cost 10K:**
Projects with Indigenous participants are eligible for a reduced partner contribution. Each BSI internship unit is valued at $10,000 and the partner organization's financial contribution starts at $2,500 per unit. Each intern receives a minimum $10,000 stipend per unit.

☐ **Business Strategy Internship (BSI) - Indigenous Pathways Reduced Cost 15K:**
Projects with Indigenous participants are eligible for a reduced partner contribution. Each BSI internship unit is valued at $15,000 and the partner organization's financial contribution starts at $3,750 per unit. Each intern receives a minimum $10,000 stipend per unit. The additional $5,000 in funds can be used to pay for eligible project costs or can be used to top-up the intern stipend to $15,000.

P-5.2 INTERNSHIP DETAILS

P-5.2a Intern Name

** NOTE: An intern can be named (if known) or TBD*

[INSERT TEXT]

P-5.2b Degree Program During Internship

NOTE: A recent graduate is an individual who, at the start of the internship, graduated less than 2 years ago. "Other University Program" should be used for an individual who is enrolled at a

Canadian university in a non-degree program (e.g., diploma, certificate). "Recent Graduate (Other University Program)" should be used for an individual who, at the start of the internship, graduated less than 2 years ago from a non-degree program (e.g., diploma, certificate).

- ☐ College
- ☐ Bachelors
- ☐ Masters
- ☐ PhD
- ☐ PDF
- ☐ Recent Grad – College
- ☐ Recent Grad - Bachelors

P-5.2c Internship timing

a. *Start date: January 5, 2026*
b. *Duration (months): 8*
c. *# of Consecutive Internships With Same Stipend (see * below): 2*
d. *End date: This auto-generates in the system based on the start date and the duration of the internship*

> * NOTE: 'Consecutive internships' refers to sequential internships performed by a specific intern without breaks (gaps) in between each. To create a break between internships, create a new row for that specific intern. To enable each internship for a given intern to have a different stipend value from the other internships for the same intern, please create a new row for that specific intern. 'Same stipend' refers to every internship for that specific intern being assigned the same stipend value. Tip: Use the Duplicate function in the Actions menu to copy internships that are similar then make simple edits (such as modifying the stipend value, internship length, or add a new intern with the same stipend, duration and sequence as previous additions) as outlined above.

P-5.3 ACADEMIC SUPERVISORS

P-5.3a Participant details

This information will be auto-generated from the "Participants" tab.

P-5.3b Partner organizations

The total minimum required organization contributions are listed in section P-3.1 above. This contribution can be distributed across multiple organizations.

a. *Please note that the financial contribution of organizations is subject to applicable Goods and Services Tax (GST), Harmonized Sales Tax (HST) and/or Quebec Sales Tax (QST) (Collectively the value added tax or VAT).*

b. *Partner organizations can contribute additional funding to the project but Mitacs will not provide any additional matching funding outside of the standard awards.*
c. *Additional partner contributions are only allowed with academic institution approval.*
d. *Any additional partner funding must be shown in the proposal/budget and the anticipated use of these funds must be explained so that the academic institution can clearly see and approve the planned budget when they sign-off on the proposal (e.g. will the extra funds be used for stipend top-up, specialized equipment, etc.?).*
e. *Any additional funds associated with a specific internship must be received by Mitacs at the same time as the normal partner contribution.*
f. *The funds will be added to the award and forwarded to the academic institution to be paid out to the intern.*

PARTNER NAME	IS A PARTICIPANT OF THIS INTERNSHIP (See * below)	AMOUNT PER INTERNSHIP (See ** below)
Partner A	*Auto-generated based on "Participants" tab*	*$7,500*

** Make sure each participant has been entered in the "Participants" tab.*
*** Note this amount does not include the tax component*

P-5.4c Stipends and Project Expenses:

a. *Partner organizations can contribute additional funding to the project but Mitacs will not provide any additional matching funding outside of the standard awards.*
b. *Additional partner contributions are only allowed with academic institution approval.*
c. *Any additional partner funding must be shown in the proposal/budget and the anticipated use of these funds must also be shown so that the academic institution can clearly see and approve the planned budget when they sign-off on the proposal.*
d. *Any additional funding associated with a specific internship must be received by Mitacs at the same time as the normal partner contribution.*
e. *The funds will be added to the award and forwarded to the academic institution to be paid out to the intern.*
f. *A minimum of $10,000 per internship must be use for intern stipend. Any additional funding the partner organization provides will be allocated to the intern stipend amount.*

BUDGET ITEM	AMOUNT
Stipend (must be at least 10,000)	$20,000
Project Expenses (usually $5,000)	$10,000
Total	**$30,000**

P-5.4d Details of project expenses.

If your internship includes project expenses, you must enter details of these project expenses in the space provided. For example, if you have two four-month internships listed above, please include what expenses will be required for each of these two units.

The project expenses for the 2 IU included in this application will be used to top-up the intern's stipend.

Section 6: Declarations

6.1 DECLARATIONS FROM PORTAL

P-6.1 Answer the following questions:

a. Will the intern conduct any of the proposed project activities outside of the academic institution or partner premises?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

b. Does the project involve:

a. Human participants whose data, or responses to interventions, stimuli, or questions by the intern, are relevant to completing the work?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

b. Secondary use of human data or health information (even if anonymized)?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

c. Human biological materials, as well as human embryos, fetuses, fetal tissue, reproductive materials, and stem cells? This applies to materials derived from living and deceased individuals

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

d. Secondary use of biological materials (even if anonymized)?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

If Yes was checked for any of the questions above, applicants must contact the ethics offices at all participating academic institutions to determine whether ethics clearance is required. This includes primary/secondary use of human data/biological materials owned by the partner.

c. Will the proposed project require the use of laboratory animals, and/or potentially impact the well-being of wild/domesticated animals?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

If yes, applicants must contact the animal care committees at all participating academic institutions to determine whether any certifications/authorizations are required.

d. Will the proposed project require the interns to handle or be exposed to biohazards?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

If yes, please check all that apply:

e. Biohazards (e.g., viruses, bacteria, fungi, parasites, toxins, prions, zoonotic pathogens, recombinant DNA, genetically modified organisms, viral vectors, synthetic organisms, cell lines/cultures)

☐ *Yes* ☐ *No*

f. Radioactive materials

☐ *Yes* ☐ *No*

g. Restricted substances (e.g., cannabis)

☐ *Yes* ☐ *No*

h. Other:

☐ *Yes* ☐ *No*

If one or more options were checked, any necessary documentation must be obtained in accordance with all participating academic institutions' policies and maintained throughout the duration of the research project.

e. Will the project involve the use of personal data or large datasets that could be considered sensitive (for additional information, see List 2 of Annex A of the National Security Guidelines for Research Partnerships)?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

If yes, please describe:

f. Will the project involve research related to critical minerals and/or one of the critical infrastructure sectors?

☒ *Yes* ☐ *No*

If yes, please describe: This project involves research related to the following critical infrastructure sector: Transportation

g. Will the project involve research related to goods or technology that are included on the Export Control List (ECL) of the Export and Import Permits Act (EIPA)?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

If yes, please describe:

h. Will background intellectual property (IP) be transferred from Canadian institution(s) to the partner organization(s)?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

If yes, please describe:

i. Will intellectual property (IP) arising from the project be owned by, assigned to, or licensed to the partner organization(s)?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

If yes, please describe:

j. Does the project aim to advance any of the listed Sensitive Technology Research Areas (STRAs)?

☐ *Yes* ☒ *No*

If yes, please describe:

If yes, applicants should consider any potential research security risks associated with the nature of the proposed activities. Applicants should also consult the policies, guidelines, and requirements of their participating Canadian academic institution(s) to determine any appropriate research security risk mitigation measures based on federal and provincial government guidelines/policy statements, and to identify any necessary actions to ensure compliance with relevant government regulations and legislation (e.g., import/export laws)

6.2 DECLARATIONS FROM APPLICATION FORM

A6.2a Conflict of interest

*Mitacs **will not approve a BSI application** if the intern listed on the proposal has a position of ownership, employment, or influence over the daily operations of the partner organization. Interns with close family or intimate relationships with academic supervisors or employees of the partner organization are also ineligible. Any other real or perceived conflict of interest (COI) - for example, **past intern employment at the partner organization** - **must** be disclosed to Mitacs during the application process using the Intern Eligibility and Conflict of Interest Declaration Form. Academic supervisors must disclose any COIs through the Academic Institution Acknowledgement of COI(s) Form, and submit this documentation on behalf of their post-secondary institution when applying through the Registration and Application Portal (RAP).*

Mitacs will first determine if BSI program rules are satisfied, and if so Mitacs will then review the COI to determine whether mitigations can be enacted to manage the COI. If a COI does exist, we suggest that you contact your Mitacs Advisor prior to starting an application to ensure that the participants in this project are eligible for the program. Please view the Mitacs Conflict of Interest Policy for more information.

***PLEASE NOTE**: Failure to disclose a COI will:*

- ***Delay the project evaluation process**.*
- ***Require submission of a COI mitigation approach** satisfactory to Mitacs before project work initiates or continues.*
- ***Risk forced withdrawal from the BSI program**, should a satisfactory mitigation plan not be reached.*

Have any applicants declared a COI via the appropriate documentation?

☐ Yes, an intern

☐ Yes, an academic supervisor
☒ No

A-6.2b Indigenous engagement

Please indicate if any of the below statements are true.

☐ One or more named interns self-declares as an Indigenous person
☐ The partner organization is a for-profit organization with self-identifying Indigenous persons who hold 50% or greater ownership shares
☐ The partner organization is a not-for-profit with board membership consisting of 50% of greater self-identifying Indigenous persons
☒ The partner organization is a not-for-profit whose core mandate includes Indigenous community impact or serving Indigenous communities

** If any of the above statements are true, your organization may be eligible for enhanced leveraging via the* Mitacs Indigenous Pathways Initiative*. Please check with your Mitacs Advisor for more information.*

A-6.2c Type of innovation

Please select all the types of innovation you will significantly impact through your project. Refer to the following definition of innovation for further information: Defining innovation - OECD.

☒ Product innovation
☒ Process innovation
☐ Marketing innovation
☒ Organizational innovation